

LLM SEO Setup Guide

Make Your Website Visible to AI Search

A complete setup guide for digital marketers

Copy & paste Claude prompts included

[llms.txt](#)

[robots.txt](#)

[Bing Webmaster](#)

[JSON-LD](#)

[Review Schema](#)

[FAQ Schema](#) [Press & Authority](#)

Whiskey & Pack | whiskeyandpack.com | Updated April 2026

Make Your Website Visible to AI Search

AI-powered search is changing how people discover products and services. Tools like ChatGPT, Perplexity, Bing AI, and Google's AI Overviews now answer questions directly — pulling from websites they can read, understand, and trust.

This guide walks you through eight foundational steps to make your website visible to AI search engines. Each step includes the exact prompt you can paste into Claude to get a personalized walkthrough for your specific site.

Why this matters: Brands that set up AI discoverability now are building a compounding advantage. AI citations grow over time as crawlers re-index your content.

What you'll accomplish

- ✓ Create an llms.txt file — a structured guide for AI crawlers explaining what your site is about
- ✓ Update your robots.txt — so AI crawlers know where to find your llms.txt
- ✓ Verify in Bing Webmaster Tools — so Bing AI and ChatGPT search can index your site
- ✓ Install structured data (JSON-LD) — so AI and Google understand your products precisely
- ✓ Connect your review app — so star ratings appear in AI and Google search results
- ✓ Tag FAQ content with structured data — so AI can extract precise answers from your pages
- ✓ Add press & reviews to your llms.txt — to signal third-party authority to AI crawlers
- ✓ Clean up duplicate structured data — to eliminate markup conflicts that confuse search engines

Step	What it does	Time
1. llms.txt creation	Tells AI crawlers exactly what your brand and pages are about	15–30 min
2. robots.txt update	Points AI crawlers directly to your llms.txt	5 min
3. Bing Webmaster Tools	Unlocks AI citation tracking via Bing & ChatGPT Search	10–15 min
4. JSON-LD structured data	Gives AI precise product, price & availability data	15–20 min
5. Review schema	Connects star ratings to AI and Google search results	5 min
6. FAQ structured data	Tags Q&A; content so AI can extract precise answers	20–30 min
7. Press & reviews	Adds third-party authority signals to your llms.txt	10 min
8. Structured data cleanup	Removes duplicate markup that confuses search engines	15 min

Steps 6–8 are new additions to this guide.

1

Create Your llms.txt File

Estimated time: 15–30 minutes

What is an llms.txt file?

An llms.txt file is like a robots.txt — but for AI. It lives at `yoursite.com/llms.txt` and tells AI crawlers what your business does, what your key pages are, and how to understand your products. It's an emerging standard that major AI tools are beginning to read.

Think of it as a one-page briefing document you write for AI systems: "Here's who we are, here's what we sell, here are our most important pages, and here's how to talk about us accurately." Without it, AI has to guess — and it often gets things wrong or cites a competitor instead.

What to do

- Open Claude at claude.ai
- Navigate to your website and find your best product or category page
- Paste the prompt below into Claude — replace the bracketed placeholders with your actual details
- Claude will visit your site and build a custom llms.txt file for you
- Send the file to your developer to upload at `yoursite.com/llms.txt`

Shopify users: You can create a page at `/pages/llms` and set the URL handle to 'llms' — no developer needed. Claude will walk you through this.

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

I run an e-commerce store at `[yoursite.com]`. I want to make sure AI search engines like ChatGPT, Bing AI, Claude, and Perplexity can read and understand my website.

Please:

1. Visit my website and review my main pages
2. Audit how readable my site is for AI crawlers
3. Build me a complete llms.txt file that explains my brand, products, and key pages
4. Walk me through how to publish it on my site

My website is: `[yoursite.com]`

My platform is: `[Shopify / WordPress / Squarespace / other]`

My main products/services are: `[brief description]`

What to expect

- Claude will visit your site and read your pages automatically
- You'll receive a formatted llms.txt file ready to upload

- Claude will give you specific instructions for your platform
- The whole process takes 15–30 minutes

2

Update Your robots.txt

Estimated time: 5 minutes

What is robots.txt and why update it?

Your robots.txt file tells all web crawlers — including AI — what they can and can't access on your site. Adding one line to it tells AI crawlers exactly where to find your llms.txt file, making it faster and easier for them to discover and use it.

Without this update, an AI crawler might never find your llms.txt even if it's perfectly written. This step takes 5 minutes and has an outsized impact on how quickly your llms.txt gets picked up.

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

```
My website is [yoursite.com]. I just created an llms.txt file at  
[yoursite.com/llms.txt].
```

Please:

1. Fetch my current robots.txt at [yoursite.com/robots.txt]
2. Show me exactly what line to add to reference my llms.txt
3. Give me the complete updated robots.txt I can send to my developer
4. Explain how to update it on [Shopify / WordPress / my platform]

Note: On Shopify, robots.txt can only be edited by adding a custom Liquid template. Claude will walk you through this if you mention Shopify in your prompt.

3

Verify in Bing Webmaster Tools

Estimated time: 10–15 minutes

Why Bing specifically?

Bing Webmaster Tools is the control panel for how your site appears in Bing search — and critically, in Bing AI, which also powers ChatGPT's search results. Verifying your site here lets you see exactly how many times AI cites your pages and which queries are driving citations.

Reason	Why it matters
Bing AI + ChatGPT Search run on Bing's index	One verification covers both platforms
'AI Performance' report	Shows your AI citations by query — data you can't get anywhere else
Free to set up	Takes about 10 minutes with no ongoing cost
Baseline measurement	Gives you a before/after benchmark to prove your work is working

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

I want to verify my website [yoursite.com] in Bing Webmaster Tools so I can track how often AI search engines cite my pages.

Please walk me through:

1. How to create or log into a Bing Webmaster Tools account
2. How to verify ownership of my site
(I manage DNS through [GoDaddy / Cloudflare / my registrar])
3. How to submit my sitemap
4. Where to find the AI Performance report once I'm verified
5. What metrics to track as my baseline

Metrics to record as your baseline

Record these numbers on day one. You'll compare against them in 4 weeks.

Metric	Where to find it
Total AI citations (last 90 days)	AI Performance report
Daily average citations	AI Performance report
Top cited queries	AI Performance report > Queries tab
Total URLs indexed	Index > URL Inspection
Last crawl date	Crawl > Crawl Control

4

Install Structured Data (JSON-LD)

Estimated time: 15–20 minutes

What is structured data and why does it matter?

Structured data is code that lives on your web pages and tells search engines and AI exactly what each page contains — product name, price, availability, dimensions, reviews. Without it, AI has to guess. With it, AI can answer questions like "how much does X cost?" or "is Y in stock?" with precise accuracy from your site.

Benefit	What it means for you
Product rich results in Google	Price, availability, and rating shown directly in search results
Review star ratings	Gold stars appear in Google and Bing search results
More accurate AI answers	AI cites your exact product details instead of guessing
FAQ rich results	Your FAQ answers appear directly in search — no click required

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

My website is [yoursite.com] and I'm on [Shopify / WordPress / other platform].
I want to add structured data (JSON-LD / schema markup) to my site so Google
and AI search engines understand my products precisely.
Please:
1. Explain what structured data will do for my site specifically
2. Recommend the best approach or app for my platform
3. Walk me through the setup step by step
4. Tell me how to connect my review platform
([YOTPO / Stamped / Judge.me / other]) so star ratings appear in search results
5. Tell me what to check in 4 weeks to confirm it's working

Recommended Shopify app: JSON-LD for SEO by Ilana Davis (~\$15/month). It automatically adds structured data across your entire store including products, collections, blog posts, and FAQs.

Business Settings — shipping & returns

Inside JSON-LD for SEO, go to Business Settings to configure your return policy. This adds structured return policy data to your Organization and Product markup — helping AI accurately answer questions like 'What is their return policy?'

- Are returns allowed — set to 'Within a set number of days'
- Return window — enter the number of days (e.g. 100)
- Country — enter your two-letter country code (e.g. US)

- Return method — set to 'By mail'
- Return shipping fees — set to 'Free' if you cover return shipping

5

Connect Your Review App

Estimated time: 5 minutes

Why connect reviews?

Star ratings in search results (called review snippets) dramatically increase click-through rates. By connecting your review platform to JSON-LD for SEO, your aggregate rating data gets added to your product structured data — making it readable by both Google and AI search engines.

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

My website is [yoursite.com] and I use [YOTPO / Stamped / Judge.me] for reviews.
I've already installed JSON-LD for SEO. Please walk me through connecting my review platform so star ratings appear in Google and AI search results.
Show me where to check in Google Search Console to confirm it's working.

What to check in 4 weeks

What to check	Where	Good sign
Review snippets appearing	Google Search Console > Search Appearance	Impressions growing
Star ratings in Bing	Bing Webmaster > Search Performance	New rich results showing
AI citations mentioning ratings	Bing > AI Performance > Queries	More citation volume

6

Tag FAQ Content with Structured Data

Estimated time: 20–30 minutes

Why FAQ structured data matters for AI

AI tools are frequently asked specific questions — 'what mattress fits a Toyota Tacoma?', 'do I need a platform in my truck bed?', 'what is your return policy?'. Pages that answer these questions with clear, structured Q&A; content get cited far more often than pages with the same information buried in prose.

FAQPage structured data (schema.org/FAQPage) tells AI and Google exactly which questions a page answers and what the answers are. Even where Google no longer shows FAQ rich results in search, the markup still helps AI crawlers extract and cite your content accurately.

Where to add FAQ structured data

Page type	Best for	Priority
Product pages	Product-specific questions (dimensions, compatibility, care)	High
Landing/category pages	Buyer questions (which model, what fits my vehicle)	High
Sizing & fit guides	Vehicle-fit questions, compatibility, sizing	High
FAQ page	General brand & policy questions	Medium
Blog posts	Topic-specific questions related to the article	Medium

How to add FAQ structured data on Shopify (JSON-LD for SEO)

- Open JSON-LD for SEO app > FAQ Generator > Create New FAQ Page
- Enter a title (internal only — not shown to visitors)
- Add each question and answer using the + Add question and answer button
- Click Create FAQ Page — the app generates the metafield value
- Copy the metafield value to your clipboard
- Go to Shopify Admin > Settings > Metafields & Metaobjects > Pages (or Products/Blog Posts)
- Add a definition: namespace jsonld, key faq, type Single line text
- Open the page/product you want to tag, scroll to Metafields, paste the value, save

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

I want to add FAQPage structured data to my [page / product / blog post] at [yoursite.com/url] using the JSON-LD for SEO app on Shopify.

Please:

1. Review the page and identify the best questions to tag as structured data
2. Write the Q&A; pairs in the exact format the FAQ Generator needs
3. Walk me through adding the metafield definition in Shopify
4. Tell me how to verify it's working in the page source

Pro tip: Focus on questions people actually ask AI tools. Check your Bing AI Performance report for your top cited queries — these are exactly the questions to answer in your FAQ structured data.

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Add Press & Reviews to Your Ims.txt

Estimated time: 10 minutes

Why third-party mentions matter for AI citations

AI doesn't just read your website — it cross-checks whether the broader web validates what you're saying. A brand mentioned in Wirecutter, OutdoorGearLab, or GearJunkie carries far more weight with AI than the same claim made on your own site.

Adding a dedicated Press & Reviews section to your Ims.txt tells AI crawlers exactly where to find credible third-party validation of your brand. This directly strengthens your authority signal — one of the three core signals AI uses to decide whether to cite you.

The three AI citation signals

Signal	What it means	How to improve it
Authority	AI cross-checks whether credible sources validate your claims	Press coverage, backlinks, third-party reviews, directory listings
Relevance	Your content matches the exact query intent, not just the general topic	Question-based headings, specific answers, strong topical coverage
Extractability	AI can parse and pull answers from your content	FAQ schema, short paragraphs, direct answers early, clean markup

How to add press links to your Ims.txt

- Collect URLs for every review, roundup, or mention of your brand from credible publications
- Prioritize: Wirecutter, major vertical publications, gear review sites, news outlets
- Add a `## Press & Reviews` section to your Ims.txt with hyperlinked entries
- Place this section near the top — after Company info, before product details

Example format:

```
## Press & Reviews
- <a href="https://wirecutter.com/...">Wirecutter – Best Road Trip Gear</a>
- <a href="https://gearjunkie.com/...">GearJunkie – Product Review</a>
- <a href="https://outdoorgearlab.com/...">OutdoorGearLab – Full Review</a>
```

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

I want to add a Press & Reviews section to my llms.txt at [yoursite.com/llms.txt].

Here are my press mentions:

[paste your list of URLs]

Please:

1. Format these as a ## Press & Reviews section for my llms.txt
2. Add proper hyperlinks to each entry
3. Show me the complete updated llms.txt section to copy and paste

8

Clean Up Duplicate Structured Data

Estimated time: 15 minutes

Why duplicate structured data causes problems

Many Shopify themes — including popular ones like Turbo, Debut, and Dawn — output their own product structured data. If you've also installed a JSON-LD app, you now have two competing sets of structured data on every product page.

This causes Google to get confused about which data to use, can trigger Search Console errors, and slows down how quickly review stars appear in search results. The fix is straightforward: disable the theme's version and let your JSON-LD app be the single source of truth.

How to check for duplicates

- Go to any product page on your store
- Right-click > View Page Source
- Press Cmd+F (Mac) or Ctrl+F (Windows) and search for application/ld+json
- Count the matches — if you see more than one @type: Product block, you have duplicates
- Look for blocks using http://schema.org/ (not https) — these are usually from the theme

How to fix it on Shopify (Turbo theme example)

- Go to Shopify Admin > Online Store > Themes
- Duplicate your active theme first (safety backup)
- On your active theme, click Actions > Edit code
- In the Snippets folder, find product__structured-data.liquid
- Select all the content, delete it, and replace with a single comment line:

```
{% comment %}Structured data disabled – handled by JSON-LD for SEO app{% endcomment %}
```

- Save the file — the snippet still exists so the theme won't throw an error, but it outputs nothing
- Check for other FAQ-related snippet files (e.g. include-faq.liquid, faq.liquid) and remove any ld+json blocks from those too
- Verify the fix by searching the page source again — you should see only one Product block, from your JSON-LD app

Important: Always duplicate your theme before making code changes. If anything breaks, you can instantly restore by activating the backup copy from your theme library.

PROMPT — Copy and paste this into Claude

My Shopify store uses the [Turbo / Dawn / Debut / other] theme and I've installed JSON-LD for SEO. I want to check for and remove duplicate structured data.

Please:

1. Tell me which files in my theme might be outputting structured data
2. Walk me through safely disabling the theme's structured data
3. Tell me how to verify in the page source that duplicates are gone
4. Explain what I should see when it's working correctly

5

Measure Your Results

Estimated time: 4 weeks after setup

Set a reminder to check these metrics 4 weeks after completing setup. AI indexing takes time — don't expect overnight changes. The compounding effect builds over months, not days.

What to check	Where	Good sign
AI citations growing	Bing Webmaster > AI Performance	Daily average trending up
Review snippets in Google	Google Search Console > Search Appearance	Impressions increasing
Product snippets CTR	Google Search Console > Search Appearance	CTR above your baseline
New AI queries appearing	Bing > AI Performance > Queries	Non-brand queries growing
FAQ structured data working	Page source — search for FAQPage	Single clean FAQPage block with populated answers
Press links being crawled	Bing > Crawl > Crawl Stats	Outbound links being followed

What to Do Next

Once the foundation is live, these three content moves will accelerate your AI visibility:

- 1

FAQ Content Targeting AI Queries
Find your top AI queries in Bing Webmaster Tools and build FAQ structured data on your highest-traffic pages. AI search loves FAQ format and pulls from it frequently. Prioritize pages that answer specific product questions.
- 2

Blog Content Targeting Non-Brand Queries
Long-form guides (e.g. 'Best mattress for truck bed camping') are exactly what AI pulls from when answering research questions. Write 3 posts targeting your top non-brand AI queries from Bing Webmaster.
- 3

Press Outreach to High-Authority Sites
AI models learn from the web. Getting mentioned in industry publications, outdoor blogs, and review sites compounds your AI visibility over time. Each citation from a trusted source increases the likelihood AI will reference your brand. Add every mention you earn to your IImS.txt Press & Reviews section.